

CHRISTOPHER PALASZ

Instructional Designer | Curriculum & Learning Experience Designer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Instructional designer and curriculum developer with 10+ years of experience designing, delivering, evaluating, and refining learner-centered programs across higher education, K-12, and international settings. Portfolio demonstrates end-to-end learning experience design, needs analysis, measurable learning objectives, curriculum mapping, scenario-based learning, online course design, assessment development, usability testing, and data-informed iteration. Brings deep expertise in adult and multilingual learning, clear documentation, stakeholder collaboration, and AI-assisted prototyping, supported by an M.A. in English Rhetoric.

CORE COMPETENCIES

DESIGN & DEVELOPMENT

Instructional Design, Learning Experience Design (LXD)
Curriculum Development, Rapid Prototyping

ANALYSIS & ALIGNMENT

Needs and Learner Analysis, Backward Design
Measurable Objectives, Outcomes Alignment, Curriculum Mapping

LEARNING STRATEGIES

Scenario- and Task-Based Learning, Online and Blended Learning
Adult and Multilingual Learning, Scaffolding

ASSESSMENT & EVALUATION

Assessment and Rubric Development, Usability Testing
Data-Informed Iteration, Content QA

SELECTED INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGN & CURRICULUM PORTFOLIO

Korean City | *Language Learning App - Functional Prototype* | 2026

- Designed an end-to-end, scenario-based mobile learning experience with nine playable missions and a Study Hub; aligned authentic tasks, Korean dialogue, cumulative choices, layered scaffolds, corrective feedback, scoring, replay, and independent practice.
- Directed AI-assisted development from detailed learning and interface requirements; tested and debugged iterative builds, conducted informal usability testing, and revised task instructions when learner behavior exposed a gap between the intended goal and the understood task.

Professional & Academic English Writing | *Four-Week Independent-Study Course* | 2020; portfolio edition 2026

- Conducted a designer-led needs analysis using survey responses from 800+ Chinese university students and developed a four-week course with six outcomes, daily deliverables, staged drafting, feedback cycles, and a final essay-presentation-reflection portfolio.
- Aligned diagnostic, formative, peer, and summative assessment with an analytic rubric; applied self-regulated learning, process writing, project-based learning, model-light scaffolding, and documented modernization recommendations for accessible delivery and responsible-AI use.

IB MYP English A Curriculum Map | *Vertical & Horizontal Curriculum Alignment* | 2021-2022; portfolio edition 2026

- Contributed to a collaborative grades 6-10 map spanning 20 planned units; aligned concepts, global contexts, texts, performance assessments, MYP criteria, skill progression, and interdisciplinary transfer, incorporating feedback from colleagues, coordinators, and students.

English Teacher Handbook | *Faculty Onboarding & Implementation Support* | 2019-2020

- Authored scalable instructional guidance for a university English program and delivered faculty professional development to translate program expectations into clear, usable teaching practices.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

College of Lake County | Grayslake, IL | 2025-Present

Adjunct English Composition Instructor | Gifted Youth Instructor | Faculty Senate Representative

- Design and continuously refine Canvas-based Composition I and II courses, assignments, rubrics, assessments, models, and learner resources using course outcomes and feedback.
- Analyze diagnostic evidence and learner performance to improve instructions, scaffolds, feedback mechanisms, and learning activities for diverse adult learners.
- Represent adjunct faculty in Senate discussions, collaborating with academic leadership and communicating faculty needs and institutional priorities.

Woodland Middle School, District 50 | Gurnee, IL | 2024-2025

Grade 8 English Language Arts Teacher | eSports Coach

- Developed standards-aligned digital units, reading and writing assessments, models, and analytic rubrics; used results to identify skill gaps and revise content and instruction.
- Designed differentiated learning supports for multilingual and varied learners while collaborating with department and student-support teams.

Larkin High School, District U-46 | Elgin, IL | 2023-2024

English Language Arts & Dual Credit Composition Teacher | eSports Coach

- Developed digital and classroom curricula for grades 9, 10, and college-level Composition I and II; aligned learning objectives, performance tasks, and rubrics with state standards and college outcomes.
- Managed multiple courses, technology platforms, deadlines, assessment cycles, and learner-support needs concurrently.

Utahloy International School | Guangzhou, China | 2020-2023

IB MYP/DP English Language & Literature Teacher, Grades 6-10 and 12 | Head of House

- Designed and implemented project-based learning experiences, reusable digital resources, performance tasks, and rubrics across five grade levels.
- Mapped skill progression and used learner work, reflection data, and stakeholder feedback to revise resources, instructional methods, and scaffolds.
- Supported curriculum implementation with colleagues and led schoolwide initiatives involving students, faculty, families, and leadership.

Sun Yat-sen University | Guangzhou, China | 2019-2020

Lecturer of English

- Developed adult academic-writing and communication courses, instructional materials, assessments, feedback systems, faculty guidance, and professional development for multilingual learners.

Korea Nazarene University | Cheonan, South Korea | 2017-2019

Assistant Professor of English | Syllabus Coordinator

- Coordinated shared syllabi, outcomes, schedules, learning materials, assessments, and faculty communication across university English courses.

Earlier Curriculum Leadership | Seoul, South Korea | 2012-2017

Grade 6 English Head Teacher, Kwangwoon Elementary School | Reading & Writing Teacher, ChungAng University Elementary School

- Designed literacy curriculum, lessons, models, and assessments; shared resources and coordinated team planning across multiple course sections.

EDUCATION & LICENSURE

M.A., English - Rhetoric, Writing, and Digital Media Studies | Northern Arizona University | 2020

B.A., English Rhetoric - Professional Writing | University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign | 2006

Illinois Professional Educator License | English Language Arts, Grades 5-12; Dual Credit English Composition | Active through June 30, 2028

TECHNOLOGY & EVALUATION

Canvas LMS | Blackboard | Google Classroom | Google Workspace | Microsoft 365 | PowerPoint | Canva | Zoom | ChatGPT | Digital curriculum and assessment platforms

AI-assisted content and prototype development | Qualitative feedback analysis | Learner-performance review | Needs-survey design